Personal Statement

The wide field of informatics and computer science interests me on every level, from the theoretical foundations such as algorithms, logic and information theory to the huge range of applications such as software engineering, computer architecture and computational science. I want to study informatics at university for many reasons, one of which is my fascination with the idea of creating artificial intelligence (AI). I was first enthralled with this concept by Honda's ASIMO, the first ever running robot. Learning the extent of its capabilities in movement and intelligence and how far along current developments in AI are amazed me, but realising the limitations of ASIMO, and indeed of all current AI systems, triggered a deep interest in me for all things related to AI. Ever since then I have taken great pleasure in discovering all the latest innovations in AI technology - from Google's driver-less car to Apple's Siri - relishing in all the little steps being made towards creating true AI.

I feel that studying informatics at university level will equip me with the tools and understanding that would allow me to be part of this march towards creating ever more intelligent devices rather than just watching from the side-lines. I feel the informatics course in particular is perfect for me as it combines so many of my interests: I am keen to develop my amateur hobby of programming into a professional skill and a powerful tool I can use to engineer intelligent software systems. I am also drawn towards cognitive science as I understand that to create true AI we must first comprehend and model our own intelligence. I also love mathematics and the logic and simplicity behind it, and so I am looking forward to learning in more detail about the intimate relationship between mathematics and informatics.

I feel my academic background makes me a promising candidate for a five year undergraduate masters course in informatics or computer science. By taking Higher Mathematics two years earlier than normal I was introduced early on in my education to the principles of self-study. Self-motivation is something I have found easy in my studies due to my love of learning – no matter what the content. As long as I have had the choice I have always undertaken subjects that have a heavy science and mathematics aspect. This is because the methodology of applying critical and logical thinking in order to gain an understanding of concepts and then applying this all to problem solving is a process that not only appeals to me but is something I feel I am very good at. Through the large amount of self-studying I have done - especially over the last three years of my schooling - I have learned my own capabilities when it comes to education. By setting ambitious, yet realistic goals, I always have the confidence to know that I will achieve them.

Outwith academia, I am a passionate musician. For years I have been involved in organising and performing in countless concerts and gigs both inside and outside school, playing either solo or as a member of a number of music groups and bands. I love performing and singing in front of audiences but I also love jamming with other talented musicians. I am currently working towards Grade 8 piano, Grade 6 alto saxophone and Grade 5 classical guitar. I always make time to practise as I enjoy

playing and I have a strong drive to continue to improve my abilities as a musician. When I look to the future I see myself enjoying the university experience immensely, both within and outwith my studies. I am serious and committed about going to university and it is something that I have been looking forward to for years. The opportunity to improve my education even further is one I am lucky to be able to pursue, and I will not take that opportunity lightly.